

FREE SCORECARD FOR OWNER-OPERATED BUSINESSES

The Business Health Scorecard

Score your business out of 100 in about 10 minutes. Twenty yes-or-no questions across the five places small businesses quietly leak money, plus the published 2026 ranges that show what healthy actually looks like.

20
Money

20
Customers

20
Leads

20
Inbox

20
Marketing

Why score it at all?

Because busy and healthy feel identical from the inside. Revenue gets watched. The other four dimensions almost never do, and QuickBooks' 2026 report found 59% of US small businesses carrying overdue invoices, averaging \$17.7K. Ten minutes tells you whether that is you.

How to score

Answer honestly, from what you actually know today, not what you could look up. Every Yes is worth 5 points. No half points: if you hesitate, it is a No. Total each section, then add the five sections on the last worksheet page.

1. Money

YES = 5 PTS

Do you know, without looking anything up, roughly how much is owed to you right now? ☐

Have you personally reviewed every invoice older than 60 days within the last month? ☐

Do you reconcile invoices against actual bank deposits at least monthly?
Sent and paid are different lists. The gap between them is where money hides. ☐

Were you paid within 45 days on average over the last quarter?
Under 45 days is the healthy range for Net-30 businesses (CreditPulse, 2024). ☐

Money subtotal: _____ / 20

2. Customers

YES = 5 PTS

Is your biggest customer under 20% of your revenue?
Above 20% from one customer is rated high risk by valuation analysts (2024 to 2026 consensus). ☐

Could you name the customers who used to buy regularly and have gone quiet in the last 90 days? ☐

Do you know which customers habitually pay you late? ☐

Does any part of your revenue repeat on a schedule, like a retainer or subscription? ☐

Customers subtotal: _____ / 20

3. Leads

YES = 5 PTS

Do you record where every new lead comes from? ☐

Do you know which source produced your last five paying customers? ☐

Does every new lead get a reply within one business day?
A 2024 audit found 63% of B2B companies never answered an inbound demo request at all (RevenueHero). ☐

Do you know your rough lead-to-customer conversion rate?
The cross-industry average is 5.13% (Ruler Analytics, 2026). Knowing yours is the point. ☐

Leads subtotal: _____ / 20

4. Inbox

YES = 5 PTS

Does your business inbox reach zero, or close to it, at least once a week? ☐

Are you certain no quote or proposal is sitting unanswered in there right now? ☐

Do you follow up at least twice on every quote you send?
Sales compilations consistently find most closed deals take five or more touches, and most sellers stop after one. ☐

Do promises made over email get tracked anywhere outside the inbox itself? ☐

Inbox subtotal: _____ / 20

5. Marketing

YES = 5 PTS

If you run ads: do you know what a new customer costs you? If you do not run ads: was that a deliberate decision you made with numbers in front of you? ☐

Do you know your email open and click rates? ☐

Have you compared any marketing number of yours against a published industry benchmark in the last year? ☐

Could you say which marketing activity produced actual revenue last month? ☐

Marketing subtotal: _____ / 20

YOUR RESULT

Add it up

Money	___ / 20
Customers	___ / 20
Leads	___ / 20
Inbox	___ / 20
Marketing	___ / 20
Your Business Health Score	___ / 100

85 to 100

Excellent. You run a tight ship. Your risk is not visibility, it is time: keeping this level of watchfulness up by hand, every month, forever.

70 to 84

Good. The fundamentals are watched. The Nos you checked above are specific, findable money: usually a handful of old invoices, one quiet customer, or one lead source nobody measures.

55 to 69

Fair. This is where most owner-operated businesses land. Not because the business is bad, but because nobody can watch five dimensions at once while also doing the work.

Below 55

Poor visibility. The business may be fine, but you are flying it on feel. The good news: every question you answered No to is a specific place to look, and looking is usually all it takes.

One thing worth noticing: every question in this scorecard is a visibility question, not a talent question. Nothing here asks whether you are good at your work. It asks whether anyone is watching the five gauges. That is why scores move fast: visibility is buildable.



REFERENCE

What healthy looks like in 2026

Published ranges from primary benchmark reports, so you can put your own numbers next to something real. Sources and years included on purpose: a benchmark without a source is just an opinion.

BENCHMARK	SOURCE
59% of US small businesses carry overdue invoices; the average carried is \$17.7K	QuickBooks, 2026
Healthy collection time for Net-30 businesses: under 45 days; excellent is under 30	CreditPulse, 2024
US small businesses wait ~28.7 days on average to get paid	Xero, 2024 to 2025
Revenue concentration: under 10% from one customer is healthy; over 20% is high risk	Valuation consensus, 2024 to 2026
Average lead-to-customer conversion across industries: 5.13%	Ruler Analytics, 2026
Contacting a new lead within 5 minutes makes qualifying roughly 21x more likely than waiting 30	MIT Sloan / InsideSales, 2007
63% of B2B companies never responded to an inbound demo request	RevenueHero, 2024
Email, cross industry: open 43.46%, click 2.09%	MailerLite, 2026
Google Ads medians: conversion rate 8.18%, cost per lead \$66.69	WordStream / LocalIQ, 2026
Meta lead campaigns: average cost per lead \$27.66	WordStream / LocalIQ, 2025

Benchmarks are directional ranges, not gospel. Your own trend, measured the same way month after month, beats any industry table.

THE HONEST PART

What this score can see, and what it can't

You just scored what you know. The harder question is what your books know that you don't. A self-assessment cannot read your invoices, so it cannot tell you which specific customers owe you, who went quiet, or which lead source quietly pays for everything.

This scorecard

- Scores your visibility in 10 minutes
- Shows you which of the five dimensions is weakest
- Gives you the 2026 ranges to compare against
- Free, and honestly useful on its own

The Business Audit

- Computes your real score from your actual invoices, payments, and leads
- Names the specific invoices, customers, and sources, with the dollar amounts attached
- Re-runs every month against your goals, so the score becomes a trend
- Runs entirely on your own computer. Your data never leaves your machine, and never touches ours

When you want the version with your numbers in it, it is one page away:

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